

ServiceNow Flow Designer

Project Documentation Format

Project Title: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Team ID: 6ab75a49da631abbf0cded44

Date: October 2026

Platform: ServiceNow

Automation Tool: Flow Designer

Project Type: IT Procurement Workflow Automation

Prepared using the supplied FSD Documentation Format as the documentation structure and the supplied project reference as the source for project-specific content.

Documentation Scope

This document covers the project introduction, objectives, workflow architecture, setup and configuration steps, service catalog execution, approval flow, validation, known limitations, and conclusion for the automated standard laptop procurement process.

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Source boundary: Project-specific facts in this report are taken from the supplied reference PDF. Where the reference does not specify an implementation detail, it is explicitly marked as not specified.

1. Introduction

Project Title: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Team ID: 6ab75a49da631abbf0cded44

Team Members: Not specified in the supplied reference document.

Date: October 2026

Platform: ServiceNow

The project addresses inefficiency and manual overhead in the IT procurement process, particularly for standard laptop orders. The reference identifies delays and possible oversight during the configuration stage, which can increase user waiting time and reduce efficient resource allocation.

User Story: As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This is intended to ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, while reducing manual intervention.

2. Project Overview

Purpose

The purpose is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate procurement and configuration of standard laptops.

Objectives

- Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
- Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
- Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
- Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

Key Features

- A Flow Designer flow named “Standard Laptop Task”.
- Service Catalog trigger for the workflow.
- Automatic creation of a Catalog Task after the request is approved.
- Catalog Task short description and description set to “Laptop need to Configured”.
- Automatic assignment of the task to the “Hardware” assignment group.
- Approval condition set to “Approved”.
- The created flow is attached to the Standard Laptop service catalog item.

3. Architecture

The project uses ServiceNow Service Catalog and Flow Designer as the main workflow components. The reference describes a request-driven flow in which a Standard Laptop catalog request is approved and then used to create a Catalog Task for the Hardware group.

Stage	Component	Role in the Workflow
1	Service Catalog	User places a Standard Laptop request.

Stage	Component	Role in the Workflow
2	Approval	Request is reviewed and the approval value becomes "Approved".
3	Flow Designer	Service Catalog trigger starts the configured flow.
4	Create Catalog Task	A Catalog Task is created for the Requested Item.
5	Hardware Group	Task is assigned to Hardware for laptop configuration.
6	Catalog Task Record	Updated status, short description and assignment can be viewed.

Workflow Sequence

Standard Laptop Request → Approval → Service Catalog Trigger → Standard Laptop Task Flow → Create Catalog Task → Assignment to Hardware → Catalog Task status/configuration record.

4. Setup Instructions

Prerequisites

- Access to ServiceNow.
- Access to Flow Designer under Process Automation.
- Access to Service Catalog and Maintain Items.
- A Standard Laptop service catalog item.
- The Hardware assignment group referenced by the workflow.

Flow Creation

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Select All and search for Flow Designer.
3. Open Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. Select New and choose Flow.
5. Set the Flow Name to "Standard Laptop Task".
6. Set Application to Global.
7. Select "System user" as Run user.
8. Submit the flow.

5. Workflow Structure

The FSD template's folder-structure section is adapted here to the actual ServiceNow workflow structure described in the reference document.

Workflow Area	Contents
Service Catalog	Standard Laptop catalog item used to place the request.
Flow Designer	Flow named "Standard Laptop Task".
Trigger	Service Catalog trigger.
Action	Create Catalog Task.
Requested Item	Requested Item Record is supplied to the action.
Catalog Task	Task record created from the requested item.
Assignment	Assignment group set to Hardware.
Approval	Approval value set to Approved.

Flow Action Configuration

- Add an action and search for "Create Catalog Task".
- Use the Requested Item Record in the Request item field.
- The table is populated as a Catalog Task.
- Set Short Description to "Laptop need to Configured".
- Add the Description field with the same value.
- Set Assignment group to "Hardware".
- Set Approval to "Approved".
- Leave remaining fields at their default values.
- Save the Flow and activate it.

6. Running the Procurement Workflow

Assign the Flow to the Standard Laptop Catalog Item

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Select All and search for Maintain Items.
3. Open Maintain Items.
4. Search the Name field for Standard Laptop and select the record.
5. Open Process engine.
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Select the flow named "Standard Laptop Task".
8. Save the record.

Place and Process a Standard Laptop Order

1. Open Service Catalog.
2. Select Hardware.

3. Find and select Standard Laptop.
4. Click Order Now to place the request.
5. Open the order status and select the Request Number.
6. Open the Requested Number record.
7. Scroll to the Approvers section.
8. Open the record and select Approve.
9. Open the Requested Item section and select the Requested Item record.
10. Scroll to the Catalog Tasks section and open the task record.

7. Flow and Catalog Task Configuration

The following configuration values are explicitly documented in the reference project.

Configuration	Value
Flow Name	Standard Laptop Task
Application	Global
Run user	System user
Trigger	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task
Short Description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment Group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

API Documentation

The supplied reference describes ServiceNow Flow Designer and Service Catalog configuration, but it does not specify REST/SOAP endpoints, request methods, parameters, or API response examples. Therefore, API details are not applicable or not specified in the supplied project reference.

8. Approval and Access Handling

The workflow includes an approval stage. The Flow action is configured with Approval = "Approved", and the execution steps instruct the user to open the Approvers section and select Approve before checking the resulting Requested Item and Catalog Task.

Authentication / Authorization

The supplied reference does not document authentication mechanisms, tokens, sessions, roles, or authorization rules. It only specifies "System user" as the Run user for the flow. Detailed access control information is therefore not specified in the source document.

9. User Interface / Service Catalog

The user-facing part of the workflow is the Service Catalog. The documented path is Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop → Order Now. After submission, the request status, Request Number, Approvers, Requested Item, and Catalog Tasks sections can be used to follow the workflow.

UI elements explicitly referenced by the project

- Service Catalog.
- Hardware category.
- Standard Laptop item.
- Order Now action.
- Order status.
- Request Number record.
- Approvers section.
- Requested Item section.
- Catalog Tasks section.

10. Testing and Validation

The reference validates the workflow by following the request through approval and into the Catalog Task record. The expected result is that the task shows the configured short description and Hardware assignment.

Test Area	Validation Step	Expected Observation
Flow	Save and activate Standard Laptop Task.	Flow is active for use.
Catalog Item	Assign the flow to Standard Laptop.	Flow is selected as the process engine automation.
Request	Place a Standard Laptop order.	Order/request is created.
Approval	Open Approvers and select Approve.	Request proceeds after approval.
Catalog Task	Open Catalog Tasks under the Requested Item.	Task record is available.
Task Details	Inspect task status/details.	Short description and assigned group are updated.

11. Screenshots or Demo

The supplied reference PDF documents the workflow as numbered ServiceNow steps, but it does not provide embedded screenshots in the extracted project content. To avoid inventing visuals, this documentation does not reproduce or fabricate screenshots.

Recommended screenshots for a final submission

- Flow Designer page showing the “Standard Laptop Task” flow.
- Service Catalog Standard Laptop item and Order Now screen.
- Request record with the Approvers section.
- Requested Item record with the Catalog Tasks section.
- Catalog Task record showing the updated short description and Hardware assignment.

12. Known Issues

The reference identifies the existing process as having delays, manual overhead, and potential oversight or delay during laptop configuration. These are the problems the automation is designed to address.

- Manual intervention in the procurement and configuration process.
- Potential delay in configuring standard laptops.

- Potential oversight during the configuration stage.
- User waiting time caused by delayed configuration.
- Inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

13. Future Enhancements

The supplied reference does not provide a dedicated future-enhancement list. The items below are therefore documentation placeholders derived from the project's stated goals rather than claimed as implemented features.

- Further reduce manual intervention in related procurement activities.
- Extend automation to additional standard IT hardware requests.
- Improve monitoring of task status and configuration progress.
- Provide additional workflow reporting for procurement operations.

14. Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow Flow Designer, the project addresses the inefficiencies and manual overhead described in the reference. The workflow creates a Catalog Task after approval and assigns it to the Hardware group for configuration. The documented process is intended to support timely laptop configuration, reduce user waiting time, optimise resource allocation, and improve productivity within IT procurement.

Project Metadata Summary

Project	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Date	October 2026
Team ID	6ab75a49da631abbf0cded44
Platform	ServiceNow
Core Tool	Flow Designer
Primary Service	Standard Laptop
Assignment Group	Hardware

End of Project Documentation